

The Five Passes

Kept at the desk, read before every close. Run in order, in one thirty-minute block, before anything ships.

Pass 1 · Quality

Read or run the whole deliverable end to end, as the recipient will.

Pass 2 · Edge cases

Check the boundaries: first use, odd input, unusual volume. Check the handoff points for gaps.

Pass 3 · Handoffs

Receiver named and notified. They have everything needed to act without asking you.

Pass 4 · Loose ends

Open comments resolved or assigned. Placeholder text, stale links, unsent notifications cleared.

Pass 5 · Sign-off

Checked against the definition of done. Named confirmer has said done.

One row per deliverable. This is the record that makes a skipped pass a decision, not an accident.

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